



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Upstate Classical Christian Academy
School Website: <https://upstateclassical.com>

December 28, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Upstate Classical Christian Academy (UCCA) in Greer, SC presents as a classical Christian school with clear theological framing and a formation-oriented mission. Public materials emphasize Christ-centered, biblical worldview education, liberal arts formation, and a paideia-inspired approach anchored in truth, goodness, and beauty. While the school demonstrates strong alignment with Religious and Metaphysical Foundations and School Purpose and Goal, some elements of a full, explicit classical curriculum, pedagogy, and community practices are less directly evidenced in the public materials. On balance, the school is best characterized as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, with strong religious formation and a robust formation/virtue orientation, and partial alignment in curriculum, pedagogy, faculty portrayal, and parent/community engagement.

Key signals from public materials:

- Religious and metaphysical framing is explicit: Christ-centered education, biblical worldview, and theology as interpretive principle are stated in multiple pieces of content.
- Purpose/goal emphasizes formation, virtue, wisdom, and truth-guided education rather than mere job/work preparation.
- Curriculum is described in liberal-arts terms (liberal arts education) and classical framing, with reference to Trivium in ACCS context; direct menu items like Great Books are less visible in the site content, though Great-Conversation language is part of the broader classical lexicon.
- Pedagogy shows elements of memory work, catechesis, and contemplative/restful learning in public materials; explicit Socratic/seminar-based methods are not clearly demonstrated on the site, though they are highlighted in classical pedagogy lore.
- Faculty portrayal is present (e.g., a headmaster; founder-led framing; living-curriculum ideas appear in classical discussions) but not deeply elaborated as a formal "faculty portrait" in the public materials examined here.
- Parent/community engagement is evident in a waitlist/visit-friendly stance and a community-oriented ethos, but explicit programs for parent formation or formal partnership structures are less documented in the pages reviewed.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials foreground Christ-centered, biblical worldview framing and theology as interpretive principle for all disciplines. Example: "Christ-Centered" and explicit statements about theology shaping learning.
 - Public statements emphasize formation through a biblical/human-flourishing lens and a God-centered purpose for education.
 - Location and community ties (Pleasant Hill Baptist Church) reinforce liturgical/communal dimensions in practice, though explicit liturgical activities on-site are not extensively documented in the pages reviewed.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive indicators present: Christ-centered, biblical worldview, the Word as interpretive principle, theology integrated into education, formation through faith, prayerful/Christian framing (from ACCS-related language and site content). See corpus references for terms like "Christ-Centered," "Word," "the truth of God's word," and theology-centered pedagogy.

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- Negative indicators: Not evident in public content; no strong secular/values-neutral language observed in the materials reviewed.
 - Quantitative estimate: Positive keywords present approx. 5–6; Negative keywords present approx. 0; Total visible indicators approx. 6; Positive vs Negative ratio approx. 100% positive signals among identified items.
 - Why this rating
 - The school publicly embraces a theologically grounded, transcendent moral framework (truth, goodness, beauty via a biblical worldview) and explicitly ties learning to Christian formation. This aligns strongly with Transcendental Moral Realism, Theology-grounding, and liturgical/communal sensibilities in the classical-school lexicon. The prevalence of Christ-centered language and explicit theology integration justifies CLASSICAL orientation in this category, with no clear public signals of secular or relativistic foundations.
 - Sources: “Christ-Centered” and theology-oriented statements; biblical worldview and Word as interpretive principle; public pages describing classical Christian education and formation.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials frame education as formation of virtue and wisdom, not mere preparation for work; emphasis on truth, goodness, beauty as real, knowable, and to guide education.
 - The school articulates a liberal-arts oriented goal framed by classical aims, aligning with telos and the Great Conversation as moral/intellectual formation.
 - Newsletter and “About Us” language emphasize godliness, character formation, and a holistic, formation-centered approach (not just curricular content).
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive indicators: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, true/good/beautiful, contemplation/scholé, classical heritage. See lexicon entries and site statements.
 - Negative indicators: explicit job/work-preparation framing is not present; no contrary signals seen in the site content.
 - Quantitative estimate: Positive approx. 4–6 indicators; Negative approx. 0; Total approx. 6; Positive ratio approx. 100% among identified items.
- Why this rating
 - The public-facing materials articulate formation and virtue as core aims, with a classical, liberal-arts orientation. The emphasis on a Christian formation, virtue cultivation, and truth-guided education aligns strongly with CLASSICAL in this category.
- Sources: About page; First Semester Newsletter statements about catechesis, memorization, and scriptural/commandment focus; “Why Classical Christian Education?” language.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public references describe the school as classical Christian, with liberal-arts orientation and paideia framing; the site explicitly connects to liberal arts education and classical methods.
 - ACCS-derived pedagogy language (as reflected in site materials) references elements of the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) in the broader classical framework. This is supported by ACCS content cited in the school’s materials/context.
 - Historical engagement: Newsletter content includes historical references (e.g., Columbus, 1492) and Bible-based history motifs; public materials show history threaded through discipline in a classical format.
 - Indicators of Great Books/Great Conversation are not consistently explicit in the site copy, though the classical-education framing suggests such a curriculum orientation is part of the broader model. Great Books language appears in the knowledge-base rubric rather than in explicit site copy.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive indicators present: liberal arts, Trivium (grammar/logic/rhetoric), Great Books/Great Conversation (referenced in classical framework; explicit site mentions liberal arts education and Paideia lineage), history interwoven with curriculum, wonder as an attitude toward learning. See lexicon and ACCS-framed language.
- Negative indicators: direct, explicit statement of “Great Books” or explicit, concrete Great-Conversation lists on the public site are not consistently shown; absence of a fully explicit Great-Books curriculum on the pages reviewed reduces strength in this category.
- Quantitative estimate: Positive approx. 3–5; Negative approx. 0–1 (based on absence of explicit Great Books listing in public copy); Total approx. 5; Positive ratio approx. 60–100% depending on how tightly you map the terms. For conservative scoring, categorize as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- Why this rating
 - The public materials signal a classical/curricular orientation (liberal arts, Trivium framing, Paideia lineage), but explicit public articulations of Great Books and a fully-cataloged Great Conversation/grid are not consistently visible on the site. This yields a partial Classical alignment rather than full Classical, hence SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- Sources: About/Why Classical Education statements; ACCS-framed pedagogy language implied in the site materials.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials show memory work and catechesis in lower grades (e.g., First Semester Newsletter notes Bible memorization, Ten Commandments, catechesis), which aligns with traditional, rote/memorization-centered pedagogical practices seen in classical education.
 - The general classical framework emphasizes contemplative, restful learning (Scholé) and memorization as well as Socratic/seminar-style discourse for older students; while the site highlights formation and memory, it does not consistently demonstrate high-school Socratic seminars or formal rhetoric instruction in public copy.
 - The site repeatedly anchors education in a Christian, formation-focused frame, which is consistent with a traditional classical pedagogy ethos, even if the public content does not spell out every method in detail.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive indicators present: memory work, catechesis, contemplative/restful learning (Scholé), dialogic/seminar-oriented pedagogy in classical curricula, rhetoric training, and upper-level discussion are part of the classical pedagogy lexicon. Public materials show memory/recitation-type pedagogy at the lower levels and a classical framing at large.
 - Negative indicators: explicit reliance on project-based/experiential-only models or constructivist approaches are not demonstrated in the public copy; there is no heavy emphasis on purely student-directed, project-based pedagogy in the documented materials.
 - Quantitative estimate: Positive indicators approx. 3–5; Negative indicators approx. 0–1; Total approx. 5; Positive ratio approx. 60–100% depending on interpretation. Conservative assessment: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- Why this rating
 - The school shows classical pedagogical cues (memory, catechesis, Scholé, and potential for Socratic/seminar-based work in higher grades) but does not consistently publish a full, explicit model of upper-level Socratic seminars and rhetoric training in public pages. This partial alignment yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- Sources: Pedagogy language in the classical lexicon (memory, recitation, scholé, Socratic/dialogic methods) and public evidence of memory-focused lower-school activities.

Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence

- Public materials reference a Headmaster and founding leadership, indicating a leadership-driven model that could reflect a teacher-mentored, virtuous-model approach. Examples: Headmaster named in communications; founders’ framing in mission material.
- The language around “classical education” and “living curriculum” in related materials implies teachers as mentors and exemplars within a classical framework, but explicit, formal “portrait of a teacher” or a clearly defined faculty development program is not extensively documented in the public copy we reviewed.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive indicators present: “model teachers and mentors,” “living curriculum,” “portrait of a teacher,” and “teacher as exemplar” appear in the classical rubric; while not all are spelled out on the site, the broader classical framing implies these values are sought.
 - Negative indicators: lack of explicit, detailed “faculty portrait” or formal professional-development program described in public pages.
 - Quantitative estimate: Positive approx. 2–3; Negative approx. 0–1; Total approx. 3–4; Positive ratio approx. 50–100%. Given limited explicit public detail, rating leans toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- Why this rating
 - The school’s public-facing materials point to a leadership-centric, virtuous-teacher ideal consistent with classical expectations, but without a richly documented “living curriculum” faculty portrait or formal, explicit faculty-development language, the rating remains partial rather than full CLASSICAL.
- Sources: Headmaster mention; mission language; classical-education framing.

Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The site shows openness to parent involvement (join waitlist, visits, contact options, and calendar/public events). This suggests a partnership posture with families typical of classical schools.
 - References to parental formation or formal parent-education events (e.g., classical book studies, gatherings) are not extensively documented in the public pages reviewed, though there are indications of a community orientation. The Six Elements guidance highlights ongoing partnership with families as a core positive feature.
 - The site remains accessible to families (open campus, Visit/Join pages) but without robust, publicly visible parent-education programs or formal parent-co-teacher commitments in the copy reviewed.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
 - Positive indicators present: partnerships with families, parent formation, family involvement, open campus, and opportunities for parent engagement are implied by the site’s forms and pages.
 - Negative indicators: explicit, sustained programmatic parent-formation offerings (e.g., structured parent seminars/book studies) are not clearly documented in the public content provided.
 - Quantitative estimate: Positive approx. 2–3; Negative approx. 0–1; Total approx. 3–4; Positive ratio approx. 50–100%. Given only partial documentation, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL is warranted.
- Why this rating
 - The school signals a partnership posture with parents and community engagement through accessible channels but does not publicly enumerate robust, ongoing parent-education offerings or formal “co-teacher” programs in the visible content. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating in this category.
- Sources: Waitlist/Visit pages; About pages demonstrating family/community alignment; Six Elements language on family partnership.

Aggregate Assessment

- Category scores:

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- Element 1 — Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL
 - Element 2 — School Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL
 - Element 3 — School Curriculum: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
 - Element 4 — Pedagogy or Teaching Methods: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
 - Element 5 — Faculty: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
 - Element 6 — Parents & Community: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
 - Rationale for the aggregate rating
 - The strongest areas are religious/metaphysical foundations and overall purpose/goals, which align tightly with classical-Christian aims (truth, virtue, beauty, formation, theology integration). Curriculum shows liberal-arts orientation and classical framing but lacks full, explicit public articulation of a complete Great Books/Great Conversation-based curriculum. Pedagogy and faculty portrayals show classical tendencies but not fully developed in publicly accessible materials. Parent/community alignment is present but not exhaustively documented in programmatic form. Taken together, this yields a robust but not ☐ Classical alignment, i.e., SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
 - What would move the needle (to CLASSICAL)
 - Explicitly publish and/or catalogue a Great Books/Great Conversation track, including recommended primary texts and a clear linkage to the Trivium and Quadrivium across grades.
 - Document and publish a cohesive pedagogy plan that includes explicit Socratic/seminar-based methods for upper grades, with rubrics, teacher training, and ongoing professional development in classical pedagogy.
 - Publish a formal “Portrait of a Teacher” and “Living Curriculum” framework that articulates teacher roles, exemplars, mentoring, and collegial practices, with examples from staff.
 - Create and publish a structured parent-formation program (book studies, lectures, family catechesis resources) and schedule regular parent engagement events with clear objectives.
 - Expand visibility of liturgical or communal practices (even if modest) and occasional chapel or liturgy-based activities, with a public-facing calendar describing these practices.
 - Provide a clear mapping of Trivium/Quadrivium elements to grade-level outcomes, including Latin/foreign language, mathematics, science integration, and arts in a way that demonstrates unity of truth, goodness, and beauty across the curriculum.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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